

Meoncross School History Department

YEAR 8 SCHEME OF WORK (2026-2027)

Curriculum Planning & Lesson Companion

Key Stage 3 Curriculum Intent & Pedagogical Architecture

1. Curriculum Rationale & Local Maritime Heritage

Our Key Stage 3 history curriculum is intentionally constructed to link national and global historical narratives with the distinctive maritime geography and lived environment of Meoncross pupils. From the industrial revolution of the Fareham ironmaster (Henry Cort at Funtley) to the strategic supremacy of Portsmouth Royal Dockyard and the profound sacrifices recorded on the Stubbington village war memorials, history is made tangible, relevant, and deeply rooted in our coastal community.

2. Disciplinary Progression & Historical Enquiry

Across Years 7, 8, and 9, disciplinary thinking progresses sequentially to secure the foundational skills required for GCSE excellence:

- **Chronological Rigour & Global Encounters:** De-centering traditional anglocentric narratives by examining early global trade, Indigenous perspectives in Australia, and African resistance to the Transatlantic Slave Trade alongside British social transformations.
- **Causation & Consequence:** Moving from simple direct triggers in Year 7 to evaluating multi-tiered, long-term geopolitical catalysts (e.g. European alliance systems, naval arms races).
- **Source Utility & Forensic Evidence:** Progressing from basic comprehension to rigorous interrogation of provenance, evaluating authorial motive, audience, and historical reliability.
- **Historiographical Debate:** Engaging pupils with active academic debates (e.g., assessing the Magna Carta, or challenging the 'Lions led by Donkeys' narrative of the Great War) grounded in historical evidence.

3. Adaptive Teaching, Dual Coding & Inclusion

Pupils work through bespoke printed A4 workbooks closely paired with our digital learning portal. Standardized 3-tier scaffolding (Bronze sentence starters, Silver connectives, Gold historiographical analysis), consistent dual coding, and digital accessibility features offload working memory, ensuring all SEND and lower-attaining pupils achieve ambitious historical progress with zero cognitive overload.

KS3: Early Modern World & Global Encounters (1450–1750)

Year 8 | How 'global' was Britain's transformation between 1450 and 1750?

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives	Core Assessment & Tasks
Lesson 1 Who held global power in 1450?	• Identify the major global powers and trading hubs in the year 1450. • Explain how the Ottoman Empire and West African kingdoms controlled global wealth. • Evaluate why Western Europe was on the periphery (edges) of world trade in 1450.	• Assessment: PEEL Paragraph (Enquiry): What was the primary motivation for early global explorers? • Evaluating Primary Evidence
Lesson 2 How did religious conflict trigger global exploration (1517–1588)?	• Explain how the Protestant Reformation shattered European unity after 1517. • Analyze the role of Elizabethan privateers in challenging Catholic Spain's global monopoly. • Evaluate how the Spanish Armada (1588) marked a turning point in Britain's imperial ambitions.	• Assessment: PEEL Paragraph (Causation): How did religious conflict directly cause the expansion of English maritime power between 1517 and 1588? • Interrogating Historical Sources

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives	Core Assessment & Tasks
Lesson 3 Trade or takeover: How did early encounters turn into empire?	- Explain how joint-stock corporations (like the East India Company and Virginia Company) funded early English expansion. - Compare the early English colonial encounters in North America (Roanoke and Jamestown) with mercantile trade in Mughal India. - Evaluate the turning point where peaceful commercial trade shifted into territorial takeover and subjugation.	- Assessment: PEEL Paragraph (Comparison): How did the English encounter with the Mughal Empire differ from their encounter with Native Americans in Virginia? - Primary Source Analysis - Exam Practice Writing
Lesson 4 James I and the Gunpowder Plot: Why was religious division so volatile?	- Explain how the Elizabethan legacy and King James I's broken promises heightened Catholic desperation by 1604. - Analyse the conspiracy hatched by Robert Catesby and Guy Fawkes beneath Parliament and evaluate the discovery through the Monteagle Letter. - Evaluate competing historical interpretations regarding whether Robert Cecil discovered or manufactured the conspiracy.	Working with Contemporary Accounts
Lesson 5 Who controlled Britain? The Ideological Battle	- Explain how Charles I's belief in the Divine Right of Kings and eleven years of Personal Rule provoked civil war with Parliament. - Analyse how the creation of the New Model Army transformed the war and led to the unprecedented trial of the King for high treason. - Evaluate the revolutionary consequences of the Regicide and the establishment of the English Commonwealth.	Evaluating Primary Evidence
Lesson 6 Who controlled Britain? The Economic Shift	- Explain how Oliver Cromwell's Navigation Acts (1651) established a state policy of mercantilism and challenged Dutch naval hegemony. - Analyse how the founding of the Bank of England (1694) and the National Debt created a powerful Fiscal-Military State. - Evaluate the extent of economic change and continuity in Britain's domestic wealth and global colonial exploitation by 1720.	Interrogating Historical Sources
Lesson 7 What were the mechanics of the Transatlantic Slave Trade?	- Explain the three stages of the Triangular Trade and analyse how British manufactured commodities fueled human trafficking on the West African coast. - Analyse the physical and psychological brutality of the Middle Passage using forensic primary evidence from the Brookes slave ship diagram. - Evaluate the utility of contemporary sources and plantation records for investigating the dehumanisation and industrial exploitation of enslaved people in the Caribbean.	Primary Source Analysis
Lesson 8 How did enslaved Africans resist the Transatlantic Slave Trade?	- Analyse the "spectrum of resistance" and explain how covert defiance, cultural preservation, and work slowdowns enabled enslaved people to maintain their humanity. - Evaluate the military significance of Queen Nanny and the Jamaican Maroons, who forced the British Empire into signing peace treaties in 1739. - Assess the historical agency of Black abolitionists, focusing on Olaudah Equiano and the Sons of Africa, in shifting British public opinion against the slave trade.	- Working with Contemporary Accounts - Analytical Essay

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives	Core Assessment & Tasks
Lesson 9 How 'modern' was Britain by 1750? (Synthesis & Assessment)	- Synthesise political transformations from absolute divine monarchy to constitutional parliamentary oligarchy following the 1689 Bill of Rights. - Contrast the extraordinary imperial, mercantile, and financial power of London with acute domestic poverty, the Bloody Code, and the Gin Craze. - Formulate a sustained, nuanced historical judgement evaluating whether Britain by 1750 can genuinely be characterized as "modern".	Evaluating Primary Evidence

KS3: Industrialisation, Empire, and Power (1750–1900)

Year 8 | Industrialisation, Empire, and Power: How did 19th-century Britain transform at home and abroad?

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives	Core Assessment & Tasks
Lesson 1 What powered the Industrial Revolution, and how did a Fareham ironmaster change the world?	- Understand the difference between the domestic system and the factory system. - Explain the significance of Henry Cort's puddling and rolling processes. - Evaluate the importance of location versus innovation in Cort's success.	<i>Narrative exploration and class discussion</i>
Lesson 2 Was industrial work progress or punishment?	- Understand the working conditions of the early Industrial Revolution with historical nuance. - Evaluate primary sources regarding child labour. - Analyse the 'Optimist vs. Pessimist' historical debate.	- Interrogating Historical Sources - Structured Paragraph
Lesson 3 Did industrialisation make British towns unlivable?	- Analyse the contrast between imperial wealth and working-class squalor. - Evaluate the usefulness of contrasting primary sources. - Understand the catalysts for public health reform.	- Primary Source Analysis - Exam Practice Writing
Lesson 4 How was the British Empire built and sustained?	- Describe how the British Empire expanded through trade, military conquest, and colonisation across Asia and Africa - Explain how religious missions, economic exploitation, and resistance shaped the experience of empire for colonised peoples - Evaluate the significance of the British Empire in transforming global trade networks	- PEEL Paragraph (Source Utility): Synthesis Assessment (8 Marks): 'The British Empire was built and sustained by technological progress rather than violence and exploitation.' To wh... - Working with Contemporary Accounts - Analytical Essay
Lesson 5 How did the Empire strike back? The 1857 Indian Rebellion	- Describe the causes and events of the Indian Rebellion of 1857 and the forms of resistance used by Indian soldiers - Explain how the rebellion challenged British imperial power and led to direct Crown rule over India - Evaluate the significance of the Indian Rebellion as an example of colonial resistance to empire	Evaluating Primary Evidence

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives	Core Assessment & Tasks
Lesson 6 How did ordinary people fight for a voice?	- Describe the key protest movements of the 19th century, including Chartism and trade unionism - Explain how industrialisation created new forms of resistance and demands for democracy and parliamentary reform - Evaluate the significance of working-class protest in expanding the power of Parliament and moving towards democracy	- PEEL Paragraph (Source Utility): Synthesis Assessment (8 Marks): 'The violent machine-breaking of the Swing Riots posed a far greater threat to the British establishment than the p... - Interrogating Historical Sources - Structured Paragraph
Lesson 7 How did the road to democracy expand?	- Describe the key reforms that expanded democracy in 19th-century Britain, including the Reform Acts - Explain how protest, resistance, and propaganda drove the gradual extension of the right to vote - Evaluate the significance of the suffrage movement in transforming British democracy by 1900	- PEEL Paragraph (Source Utility): Synthesis Assessment: To what extent was Britain a fully functioning democracy by the end of 1884? Use evidence from across the lesson to support y... - Primary Source Analysis - Exam Practice Writing
Lesson 8 Who truly benefited from 19th-century transformation?	- Synthesise knowledge of industrialisation, empire, trade, democracy, and resistance across the 19th century - Construct a sustained argument evaluating who truly benefited from Britain's transformation - Deploy specific evidence about power, colonialism, and urbanisation to support a historical judgement	- PEEL Paragraph (Argumentation): Capstone Essay (16 Marks): 'The transformation of 19th-century Britain was a triumph of progress that benefited the entire nation.' To what extent ... - Analytical Essay
Unit Key Vocabulary: Industrial Revolution • Industrialisation • Domestic System • Factory System • Puddling Process • Wrought Iron • Steam Power • Urbanisation • Slum • Back-to-Back Housing • Public Health • Cholera • Miasma Theory • Laissez-faire • Child Labour • Factory Acts • Trade Union • Captain Swing • Swing Riots • Chartism • People's Charter • Universal Suffrage • Franchise • Rotten Borough • Pocket Borough • Great Reform Act (1832) • Secret Ballot Act (1872) • Empire • Colonialism • Imperialism • East India Company • Sepoy • Indian Rebellion (1857) • British Raj • Ironclad • Two-Power Standard • Historiography • Optimist View • Pessimist View • Synthesis		

KS3: History of Australia

Year 8 | Invasion, Settlement, or Survival? How should we remember the colonization of Australia?

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives	Core Assessment & Tasks
Lesson 1 Claiming Australia	- Describe how and why the British Empire claimed Australia, including Captain Cook's voyage and the concept of terra nullius - Explain the significance of colonisation for both the British Empire and the Indigenous Australian peoples - Evaluate whether the British arrival should be understood as discovery, settlement, or invasion	<i>Narrative exploration and class discussion</i>
Lesson 2 Creating a Convict Colony	- Describe the key features of the convict transportation system and explain why Britain used Australia as a penal colony - Explain how the British Empire used convict labour to establish a colonial foothold in the Pacific - Evaluate the human cost of the convict system and its role in the revolution of Australian settlement	<i>Narrative exploration and class discussion</i>

Lesson Number & Title	Learning Objectives	Core Assessment & Tasks
Lesson 3 Encounters with the Indigenous Peoples	- Describe the impact of British colonisation on Indigenous Australian communities, including the destruction of trade, culture, and land - Explain how Indigenous Australians showed resistance to British settlement through both armed conflict and cultural survival - Evaluate the significance of these encounters for understanding the long-term consequences of empire	<i>Narrative exploration and class discussion</i>
Lesson 4 From Penal Colony to Settlement	- Describe how Australia transitioned from a penal colony to a free settlement through migration and the Gold Rush - Explain how empire, revolution, and change shaped the development of Australian society in the 19th century - Evaluate who benefited most from Australia's transformation and who was marginalised	<i>Narrative exploration and class discussion</i>
Lesson 5 Lesson 5: Assessment - What's the story of Australia?	- Synthesise knowledge of colonisation, empire, resistance, and change across the history of Australia - Construct a sustained argument evaluating whose perspective should shape how we remember Australia's history - Deploy specific evidence to support a judgement about the legacy of empire in Australia	- PEEL Paragraph (Source Utility): Write a narrative account analyzing the development of Australia between the years 1788 and 1855. - Evaluating Primary Evidence
Unit Key Vocabulary: Ancestors • Botany Bay • Colony • Gweagal • Navigator • Royal Society • Terra Nullius • First Fleet • Convict • Governor • Hard labour • Hulk • Transportation • Sydney Cove • Eora • Frontier • Guerrilla Warfare • Dispossession • Massacre • Squatter • Merino • Gold Rush • Immigrant • Xenophobia • White Australia Policy		